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https://logos.pub

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Editorial Board
Theology and Science
Routledge / Taylor & Francis

Dear Editors,

I am writing to submit the enclosed manuscript, entitled

**"Theodicy as Error Handling:
A Computational Framework for the
Problem of Evil,"**

for consideration for publication in *Theology and Science*.

Summary. The paper reframes the classical Problem of Evil as a system design problem using formal computer science. Evil is modeled as a non-terminating recursive loop (the Halting Problem), suffering as the felt experience of thermodynamic entropy, and morality as a thermodynamic optimization protocol. The Epicurean Paradox is resolved by demonstrating that its hidden premise—"prevention of all suffering is the highest good"—is false. Sovereignty (genuine agency) is the higher design objective.

Contributions.

- A formal definition of evil as non-terminating recursion, with explicit mapping to Turing's Halting Problem.
- The suffering decomposition $\mathcal{E} = H + P$ (hardware damage + perception error).
- The *Fault Isolation Theorem*: any system with autonomous agents must implement fault-isolation mechanisms.
- A thermodynamic moral vector $\vec{V} = \Delta I / \Delta S$ that unifies Aristotelian, Kantian, and consequentialist ethics.
- A formal resolution of the Epicurean Trilemma via the Sovereignty > Safety axiom.

Suggested Reviewers.

1. **Prof. Alvin Plantinga** (University of Notre Dame) — Author of the Free Will Defense, the most influential modern theodicy.
2. **Prof. Robert John Russell** (Graduate Theological Union) — Founder of the Center for Theology and the Natural Sciences.
3. **Prof. Nancey Murphy** (Fuller Theological Seminary) — Expert in the philoso-

phy of mind and divine action.

This manuscript has not been previously published and is not under consideration at any other journal. I confirm no conflicts of interest.

Respectfully submitted,

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